

07/25/26

Free Talk

TED Talk TED 演讲

Speaker notes 提示卡 (演讲的时候用的)

Cue cards 提示卡 (演讲的时候用的)

MC - Master of Ceremonies 主持人

Host 主持人

Q & A session 问答环节

Overestimate myself / think too highly of myself 高估自己

overestimate myself 高估自己

----- **Forrest** 水平

underestimate myself 低估自己

Homework Analysis

Article

Body paragraph 1.

Firstly, spending time outdoors enables young people to develop social skills and build meaningful relationships. Unlike online communication, face-to-face interactions allow individuals to better interpret emotions, facial expressions, and body language, leading to more effective communication. (For example, during a school ^{camping trip} outdoor camp, students are often required to work in teams to complete activities such as setting up tents, navigating unfamiliar routes, or solving ^{problems as a group} group challenges.)

These tasks encourage participants to communicate clearly, cooperate with one another, and develop mutual trust in order to achieve a common goal. As a result, students ^{may be likely to} become more confident in social situations while forming genuine and lasting friendships. Therefore, outdoor activities provide valuable opportunities for young people to strengthen their interpersonal skills and establish meaningful connections with others.

→ 从论点的角度写

→ 仍然是各抒己见，沟通能力会出现，没有真正的不合作，合作瞬间

→ 是和论点相关的，很棒。

Body Paragraph 1

Unlike online communication, face-to-face interactions allow individuals to better interpret emotions, facial expressions, and body language, leading to more effective communication.

↑ Forrest 的 analysis ↑

Unlike online communication, outdoor activities give young people opportunities to interact face to face while working towards shared goals. They must express their ideas, recognize other people's reactions and cooperate in real time, which helps them develop stronger social skills and gradually build trust with others.

内容与 social skills 有一定关联，但作为主题句后的 analysis，它和 point 的衔接不够紧密！

Forrest 应该写：户外活动究竟通过什么过程，帮助年轻人提高社交能力并建立关系？

Forrest 的论证：

面对面交流能够帮助人们理解非语言信息，从而更有效地沟通。

Forrest 解释的内容：

它只解释了 social skills 中的一个较窄方面：理解表情和肢体语言

可是 Forrest 没有充分解释：

- *年轻人如何练习表达和倾听；
- *如何在真实情境中合作；
- *如何通过反复互动建立信任；
- *有效沟通如何进一步发展成 meaningful relationships

Forrest 没跑题，但是解释得太窄，而且逻辑链停得太早！（之前老说的“一步到位”）-> 论点：A+B，分析：只有 A

... navigating unfamiliar routes, or solving group challenges.

搭配:

problem:

Solve problems

Challenge:

complete / take on / tackle / overcome a challenge

These tasks encourage participants to communicate clearly, cooperate with one another, and develop mutual trust in order to achieve a common goal.

↑ Forrest 的例子↑

Forrest 的例子直接下结论:

- *他们会清楚沟通
- *他们会彼此合作
- *他们会建立信任

但读者并没有真正看到:

- *谁在做什么
- *遇到了什么困难

... navigating unfamiliar routes, or solving problems as a group.

For example, during a school camping trip, a group of students may become unsure which path to follow. One student studies the map while another searches for trail signs ahead. If they disagree about the correct direction, they must explain their ideas, listen to one another and make a decision together. When they eventually reach the campsite, they realize that the group succeeded because everyone contributed. This shared experience can help them trust one another and become more confident in social situations.

- *他们说了什么或如何分工
- *合作是怎样发生的
- *为什么这次经历会建立信任

不要直接告诉读者“学生会沟通和合作”，而要写出一个需要沟通和合作才能解决的问题。

Problem → Different roles → Disagreement → Communication → Shared result → Personal change

- *Problem: They are unsure which route to take.
- *Different roles: One reads the map; another looks for signs.
- *Disagreement: They suggest different directions.
- *Communication: They explain and listen.
- *Shared result: They reach the campsite.
- *Personal change: They develop trust and confidence.

Personal Statement - Part 2-4

The whistle pierced the afternoon air as the rugby ball flew towards me. For a split second, everything seemed to slow down. I ^{reached} out confidently only to watch the ball slip through my hands and bounce across the grass. Groans echoed behind me as the opposing team regained possession. Heart rushed to my face, and I wished I could disappear.

It was only my third rugby practice, but every training session left me questioning whether I belonged on the team. I struggled to remember the rules, often found myself out of position, and was always behind my teammates. While ^{they} ~~the~~ communicated effortlessly and anticipated one another's movements, I focused only on keeping up physically. Watching everyone else work together so naturally, I began to doubt whether I had what it took to become a rugby player.

After another frustrating training session, our captain walked

over instead of criticizing me. He simply said, "you're trying to play rugby by yourself. Trust your teammates — they're here to help you." At first, I ^{convinced myself that} ~~thought my~~ biggest challenge was my lack of fitness or experience. Looking back, ~~however~~ however, I realized that my real obstacle was my ~~mindset~~. I had always believed that success came from solving problems independently and proving that I could overcome every challenge on ~~my~~ own. On a rugby field, that belief only prevented me from becoming ~~part of~~ team.

XX From then on, I made a conscious effort to change the way I ~~approach~~ approached every ~~practice~~. Rather than staying silent when I was uncertain, I began asking experienced teammates for ~~advice~~. I learned to communicate constantly during drills, call for the ball with confidence, and trust others to support me instead of trying to do ~~everything~~ myself.

Gradually, I stopped measuring my progress by the number of

mistakes I made and started focusing on how I could contribute to the team's success. As my confidence grew, so did my ability to work effectively with others.

That experience continues to shape the way I approach challenges today. Whether I am collaborating on school projects, participating in extracurricular activities, or adapting to unfamiliar environments, I now value communication, mutual trust, and teamwork over individual achievement. Rugby taught me far more than passing, tackling, or scoring tries - it showed me that meaningful success is rarely achieved alone. By learning to rely on others and contribute to a shared goal, I became not only a better teammate but also a more thoughtful and collaborative person.

New Reading/Writing Task - Text B - (f) Summary

Read **Text B**, and then answer **Question 1(f)** on the question paper.

Text B: *Who or what is Sophie the giraffe?*

Before my daughter was even born, my parents (who lived in Europe at that time) started sending presents for her. The first one to arrive was a 'Sophie the Giraffe' – a friendly-looking giraffe toy. 1

Although that's the first time I remember seeing Sophie, suddenly I saw 17-centimetre giraffes everywhere – lovingly held by the little hands they were especially designed for. There seemed to be 'Sophies' in every shop I walked into and all over social media. I had to admit her visual appeal, though, and when my daughter was born, she seemed to agree: Sophie became her companion on many adventures and three years later still goes everywhere with her. 5

When I discovered that Sophie's story began in the heart of Paris, France, my curiosity as a journalist was piqued. A man known now only as Mr Rambeau created her on 25 May 1961. Rambeau worked for a company which made a range of animal toys for children. At that time, these were based on domesticated animals, so a wild giraffe was something new and novel. 10

To learn more about Sophie, I spoke with the co-founder of the company responsible for exporting this fashionable toy around the world to over 75 different countries. 'Did you know that each year in France, more Sophies are sold than there are babies born?' she asked me. 'Sophie's milestone birthdays are big events in France, with her celebrity fans and even royalty in attendance.' 15

If you received a Sophie for a gift, or purchased one yourself, it's likely that you didn't read all the packaging. I certainly didn't, so I didn't know that (delightfully) Sophie is made in the same small French factory she started in, or that (reassuringly) she is painted with food-grade paint. Made from natural rubber, still exclusively sourced from special trees in Malaysia, this little giraffe is completely biodegradable and sustainable, as the trees aren't harmed by rubber extraction. 20

Sophie is designed to engage all five senses: her contrasting dots and dark eyes are great for young babies. She's also fun to squeeze, with a rewarding squeak for little ears and a sweet vanilla smell that babies respond to. 25

There's now a range of Sophie products on offer, from clothing and nursery fabrics to various animal 'friends', but the classic vintage Sophie will likely always be parents' favourite, winning several awards for children's toys and even appearing in a movie! 12

Read Text B, Who or what is Sophie the giraffe?, in the insert and answer Question 1(f) on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, what is appealing about Sophie the giraffe to modern parents of young children?

You must use continuous writing (not note form) and use your own words as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing. 8/10

People like Sophie because she is attractive, safe and environmentally friendly. She is still carefully made by hand in the same French factory where she was first created, giving parents confidence in its quality. The toy is painted with food-safe paint and produced from natural rubber collected without damaging the trees, making it biodegradable and sustainable. Sophie also helps babies develop their senses through her bright appearance, soft texture, squeaky sound and pleasant vanilla scent. She is easy for small hands to hold and has remained popular for generations. In addition, many related products are available, while the original version continues to receive awards and is trusted by families worldwide.

↓ 2,3,4 没提到 ↓

Question	Answer	Marks
1(f)	According to Text B, what is appealing about Sophie the giraffe to modern parents of young children? You must <u>use continuous writing</u> (not note form) and <u>use your own words</u> as far as possible. Your summary should not be more than 120 words. <u>Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.</u> Use the Marking Criteria for Question 1(f) (Table A, Reading and Table B Writing). INDICATIVE READING CONTENT Candidates may refer to any of the points below: - visually attractive / friendly-looking - specially designed for children / designed for young children - fashionable / famous / on social media - children become attached / becomes companion - big events / has celebrity fans / royal fans - still made in the same small factory (in France) / provenance / not mass produced - painted with food-grade paint / non-toxic paint / safe - biodegradable / sustainable rubber / environmentally friendly / natural rubber - engages all baby's five senses / engages different senses / stimulates / educational - range of Sophie products / Sophie themed accessories - classic / vintage / iconic / nostalgia - has won awards / (featured) in a movie	15

New Reading/Writing Task - Text C - (a-d)

4

Read **Text C**, and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** and **Question 3** on the question paper.

Text C: *Emil and the giraffes*

In this text, Emil is a science student working in the headquarters of a shipping company and is packing boxes during his long summer holiday. Emil has been unexpectedly summoned to the office of the person in charge.

'So you're the giraffe man, are you?' asks the shipping director, barely looking up as I'm ushered into his office. a-i

'Yes, I'm studying blood flow in vertical creatures – humans and giraffes. My research has applications for astronauts,' I boast. 'The giraffe's thick skin is so tightly wrapped that designers want to imitate its qualities in anti-gravity spacesuits.'

5

a-ii
'I see,' he says.

He doesn't.

'Are giraffes ferocious?' he asks, unexpectedly.

'No. Although a giraffe can kick out in any direction with force.' I know this only from my reading. Like him, I've never seen wild giraffes.

10

'Ever been to the sea?' he asks, flicking through papers on his desk.

'No, sir.'

'All the more exciting then. Let's see ...' he reads, 'thirty-three giraffes, sailing in from Africa.'

He asks if I've heard of a town in a neighbouring country. I have. Rich people ski there.

15

'What we want from you, Emil, is to meet this shipment at the port, supervise the unloading, then travel with the cargo to ensure our client's property reaches that town's zoo in good order.'

One hour later, I'm on the ship. I stare, dumbfounded. I've worked only with one living giraffe, an old zoo animal, weary, hunched. I've seen nothing like this. There are so many of them: wild and so impossibly stretched that they seem to scrape the sky. Tarpaulins cover their crates, so only their necks and shoulders are visible, like enormous hand-puppets. When they move, they flow as if underwater, or like slender trees swaying in a breeze. I take a step closer. The smell of the giraffes is pungent. I count thirty-two animals.

20

An aged sailor approaches. 'Cup your hands,' he says, pouring stale grain into them. 'Now try that one there. They call her Snowstorm.' I see why: her underbelly is a blizzard of white. Snowstorm slides her tongue out delicately towards me. It's the length of my arm and as dark as blood.

25

a-iii
The sailor outlines the plan for unloading: each animal will be transferred onto a barge alongside the ship. I will go with the barge when it heads up the river tomorrow.

30

That afternoon, I sit in the ship's library, sifting through documents estimating shipping costs, profit and loss, until I find the veterinary report. I make notes on the blood-pressure measurements recorded for one unfortunate giraffe before its voyage ended.

Next morning, unloading begins: each animal is harnessed and hoisted. Some giraffes panic at the sensation of flying, kicking out. Swinging precariously, they're lowered towards the barge and stare desperately back out to sea, shimmering hot with fear. Squawking gulls hover overhead, mocking the new arrivals as they descend, legs flailing. The sailor stands beside me. 'Let them walk on air: they'll never walk on their continent again,' he says sadly. 35

Days later, I'm journeying onwards to the zoo in a lorry carrying four of the giraffes, including Snowstorm. Bemused schoolchildren on buses catch sight of the giraffes and wave. The woods we pass are increasingly dense, not the vast, open woodlands giraffes dream of. We rattle along bumpy back roads, avoiding bridges, turning north towards the mountains along the border. 'Slower,' I tell the driver. The narrow window in the back of the cab seems to frame the giraffes' captivity. Their eyes are shut tight. 40

I step down from the lorry into a wintry, icy morning. The zoo manager strides up in his safari hat. 'Just lost one on the voyage, did you?' he sneers. 45

'I wasn't ...' I begin, but he's already talking loudly about 'this epic migration'. As if they'd choose to come here with this climate! I voice my misgivings about plans for the giraffes to spend their days outdoors in his 'safari park'. 2-11

'A free herd will attract tourists,' he shrugs. 50

'They were free,' I point out.

As I leave, Snowstorm's head raises even higher, straining to glimpse over the zoo's walls.

Read Text C, Emil and the giraffes, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

Question 2

- (a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:
- (i) The shipping director hardly takes his eyes off the papers on his desk as Emil is guided into the office.
IDK ? ?
 - (ii) People creating spacesuits want to replicate the characteristics of giraffe skin.
imitate ... imitate what?
 - (iii) The sailor explains the general features of how they intend to get the giraffes off the ship.
outlines ?
 - (iv) Emil speaks his concerns to the zoo manager.
voice my misgivings

! 答案不完整 !

Question	Answer	Marks
2(a)(i)	Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined: The shipping director <u>hardly takes his eyes off</u> the papers on his desk as Emil is guided into the office. Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer (the shipping director / he) barely looking (up) [line 1].	1
2(a)(ii)	Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined: People creating spacesuits want to <u>replicate the characteristics</u> of giraffe skin. Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer (they want to) imitate (its/the) qualities (of giraffe skin) [line 5]	1
2(a)(iii)	Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined: The sailor <u>explains the general features of how they intend to get the giraffes off the ship.</u> Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer (the sailor / he) outlines the plan for unloading [line 29]	1
2(a)(iv)	Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined: Emil <u>speaks his concerns</u> to the zoo manager. Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer (He/I) voice(s) (his/my) misgivings [line 48]	1

Homework 1 - text B summary

Homework 2 - Read the and C for next week